

SUMMARY KEYWORDS

report, thought, site, field

trip, map, geology, dunes, included, incorporate, soil, recommend, geologically, natasha, essay, details, main topic, draft, findings, soil ph, transcribe

SPEAKERS

Speaker 1 (66%), Speaker 2 (32%)

1

Speaker 1

0:00

In part three, you will hear a tutor named Mr. White discussing with his student Natasha about a draft of a field trip. First, you have some time to look at questions 21 to 26? Now listen carefully and answer questions 21 to 26. Hello, Natasha, come on in, sit down.

2

Speaker 2

0:58

Thanks, Mr. White, did you manage to look over the draft of my field trip report?

1

Speaker 1

1:03

Yes. And I have a few observations and some things I would like to see revised.

2

Speaker 2

1:09

I see. Feedback is always appreciated, positive or negative.

1

Speaker 1

1:13

Maria asks, What was your motivation in completing this report? If you want extra credit to go towards your final grade, I'm afraid it doesn't work like that.

2

Speaker 2

1:23

Not at all. I wasn't sure which aspect of science I wanted to study and thought this might help me focus. After this field trip, I realized that geology is a field I would love to be involved in. And I've signed up for a course next term. And actually, having worked on the draft, I've learned that I need practice that writing reports like these,

1

Speaker 1

1:44

I can't argue with that. Geology is one of my favorite subjects, too. But I don't advise using this report as a basis for any further assignments. The details you've included, are informative, though your organization is relatively poor.

2

Speaker 2

2:01

I will take that down. How do you feel about the introduction?

1

Speaker 1

2:05

It's not bad at all. But you need to follow it through in the main part of the essay. The school website has many essay templates you can use, including the ones for a scientific report, which is what you need here. I'd like you to download one and revise accordingly. Can you do that?

2

Speaker 2

2:25

Yes. And I am thinking about adding more details to make the report more convincing. Do you have any advice?

1

Speaker 1

2:32

Well, actually, I don't think it's necessary to do that. Your choice of survey site was an interesting one. Was there a reason you chose this particular site? We have a map in the lab which is marked with all the sites in the local area that are geologically and geographically noteworthy. But yours wasn't one of them.

2

Speaker 2

2:53

Knowing they had been repeatedly studied by geography students, I wanted to try somewhere different. I believe every place is geologically unique. So I closed my eyes and stabbed the map, then looked for the nearest open site. Fortunately, it was easily accessible.

1

Speaker 1

3:09

Interesting. What did you hope to gain from your field trip? Surprisingly, the grasses in the area you chose are quite dense, though the soil is somewhat Sandy, were you thinking of finding out any special properties in the soil that may cause this?

2

Speaker 2

3:27

Not particularly, I'm very interested in the elements that make up different soil types. And the dunes have always captured my interest because of the sand content. As an added bonus, I was also able to try out a number of the soil testing techniques you've been coaching us in.

1

Speaker 1

3:42

I noticed you've also incorporated some of your fellow students data in your report.

2

Speaker 2

3:48

Yes, in an effort to make my own findings more accurate, I thought it is wise to get a broader view by merging their data with mine.

1

Speaker 1

3:56

Good idea. Your report is reasonably comprehensive. Incorporating others findings like this also enables you to compare your methods with other people's. Yes,

4:07

I thought that would be beneficial.

1

Speaker 1

4:09

I note that you've included quite a detailed map of the site. How did you go about drawing that? I'm assuming you took photographs and used a graphics program.

2

Speaker 2

4:20

I took a satellite image with me to the viewing platform at the dunes Visitor Center. I can see the whole area from up there that I marked in the details I could see. Some of my classmates just copied the local map with tracing paper, but I didn't feel it was detailed enough. So

1

Speaker 1

4:39

before you hear the rest of the discussion, you have some time to look at questions 27 to 30. Now listen carefully and answer questions 27 to 30? What equipment did you use to survey the site?

2

Speaker 2

5:17

I predominantly use the soil pH test kit you recommended, but it's quite technical, and I found it difficult to use. There were so many buttons, and I didn't know which ones to click.

1

Speaker 1

5:28

Hmm. It is somewhat complex, since it's quite professional, but a bit of training would help. Now your data collection sheet has some issues. I know

5:39

it's a bit disorganized, isn't it? What should I do?

1

Speaker 1

5:42

Begin with the main topic, then put all the variables that you need in separate columns, and use a fresh line for each sample?

2

Speaker 2

5:51

Okay, I'll do that. I thought my literature review was good, though. clear and comprehensive.

1

Speaker 1

5:57

It didn't really give a full picture and you neglected some parts which are important. I recommend you gather a greater selection of materials. There are some excellent books and papers I can recommend to you on the subject. Oh, that would

2

Speaker 2

6:13

be very helpful. How would you feel about my notes based on conversations with local residents? You know about their experience of growing different plants in similar soil types.

1

Speaker 1

6:24

It's always a good idea to incorporate some real world experiences in a report like yours. I wasn't sure whether it's redundant, but I learned a lot. It's an established research method.

2

Speaker 2

6:36

It took a long time though. Next time I should limit the number of questions I ask or get someone to help transcribe the recordings.

6:44

You'll be asking for a research assistant next

